STUDENT SUPPORT & CULTURE · FOR THE IRI FACILITATOR · GRADES 3–4

FACILITATOR GUIDE

How to run the one-hour IRI session for 3rd and 4th graders, from setup to re-entry. The facilitator is the steady adult in the room; the forms are the tools that adult uses with each child.

USES Grade 3 and Grade 4 Repair Packet · Repair Menu · Plan for Tomorrow **PLUS** IRI Facilitator Forms

BEFORE STUDENTS ARRIVE

TEN MINUTES OF SETUP

Setup removes every reason to leave the group once the hour starts.

PEOPLE AND PAPER

- [ ] Roster confirmed with the Deans: name, trigger, same-day or next-day
- [ ] Visit count checked for each student (see Repeat Placements)
- [ ] Classwork collected for each student; missing work flagged to the restorative team
- [ ] Grade 3 or Grade 4 Repair Packet, Repair Menu, and Plan for Tomorrow per student
- [ ] Session log and perspective note forms ready

THE ROOM

- [ ] TV lesson loaded, sound tested
- [ ] Seats in a small arc facing the screen; facilitator seated at the same level
- [ ] Pencils, crayons, and math manipulatives at each seat
- [ ] A calm-down spot marked inside the room, in view
- [ ] Student Talk Card on each table

RUN OF SHOW

THE HOUR, SEGMENT BY SEGMENT

0:00 – 0:05 SETTLE

Students arrive escalated, embarrassed, or shut down. The goal is a calm body, not a conversation about the incident.

1. Greet each student by name at the door, at eye level.
2. Lead one calm-down strategy together from the Repair Packet: breathe slow, push the wall, squeeze and let go, find 5 things, or drink water.
3. Each student circles where they are on the packet: still upset, getting calmer, or ready to think. No one explains why yet.

> **SAY** "Glad you're here. You're not in trouble with me. We're going to reset first."

0:05 – 0:17 LESSON

The TV lesson teaches Pause, Choose, Repair. The facilitator runs it as a conversation, not a video to sit through.

- Stop at every response point. Students point, hold up fingers, or turn and tell.
- Use a scenario card, never a student's own incident. Students practice on someone else's situation first.
- Name that the feeling makes sense, then turn to choices. Offer more than one: pause, use words, get an adult, step back.
- Do not present "just walk away" as the only right answer. Many students are taught at home to stand up for themselves.

> **SAY** "If someone talked about my family, I'd feel that too. What are three things that kid could do next?"

0:17 – 0:30 REPAIR

Students complete the Grade 3 or Grade 4 Repair Packet with the facilitator moving between them. At this age the adult is the intervention; the packet is the tool.

§1 Slow down first. Already done in Settle; confirm "ready to think."

§2 What happened. Student checks one, then tells it in order. Their side comes first.

§3 How I felt right before. Point to a feeling word if words are hard.

§4 Who did it affect. Circle everyone, then name the one affected most.

§5 What I needed that I did not get. This feeds the perspective note.

§6 Choose my repair. Student picks from the Repair Menu; the adult does not assign it.

HOW TO SIT WITH A STUDENT

- Kneel or sit beside the student, not across. Ask one question, then wait.
- Every answer may be drawn, written, or told. When a student tells, the adult writes the student's words, not a cleaned-up version.
- When a student says "I don't know," offer two choices: "Was it more like this, or more like this?"
- While the student talks, note key phrases for the student perspective note. Use their words in quotation marks.

> **SAY** "Tell me what happened, from your side. I'm going to write down exactly what you say."

0:30 – 0:35 RESET

Every student moves: stand and stretch, a simple call and response, or a lap of the room. This is planned, not a reward.

0:35 – 0:50 ACADEMICS

Students work on the classwork the teacher sent. Hands-on work regulates students this age and keeps the hour from feeling like punishment.

- **Math:** counters, base-ten blocks, or fraction tiles for any assignment where they fit.
- **Writing:** when no assignment arrived, a short piece tied to the repair, such as a note to the person affected.
- **Quiet, not silent:** two chunks of about 7 minutes with a check-in between. Low voices to ask for help are fine.
- Check each student's work at least once. Anything unfinished goes on the session log.

0:50 – 1:00 SHARE & PLAN

Each student leaves with one sentence they can say out loud. The share is about the plan, not the incident.

1. Each student completes Repair Packet §7, Going Back, and says the Talk Card frame: "Next time I feel ___, I will pause and ___." A student may whisper it to the facilitator instead.
2. The facilitator names one specific thing each student did well this hour.
3. Hand each student the Plan for Tomorrow sheet and name the adult who will check in.
4. Close the same way every session: a group breath or a shared phrase.

WHEN A STUDENT ESCALATES

REGULATION FIRST, REPAIR LATER

The facilitator's calm sets the room's ceiling.

WHAT THE FACILITATOR SEES	FIRST MOVE	IF IT CONTINUES
Refusing to start, head down	Sit nearby. Offer a choice: "Draw it or tell me?"	Three minutes at the calm-down spot, then offer again
"I didn't do anything"	"I hear you. Tell me your side first." Start with §2.	Write their words exactly; ownership can wait
Noise, tapping, out of seat	Quiet private redirect; offer a standing spot	Move the Reset earlier for the whole group
Bothering another student	Move seats calmly, with no public correction	Separate work spaces for the rest of the hour
Yelling, throwing, unsafe toward others	Low, short voice. Move other students back. Call for support.	Follow the school safety protocol; the Deans decide next steps

MOVES THAT ESCALATE 8 AND 9 YEAR OLDS

Debating the original incident · public warnings · counting down · threats about calling home · adding consequences in the moment.

REPEAT PLACEMENTS

A RETURNING STUDENT MOVES UP A LEVEL

No student repeats the same session. Check the visit count before the hour starts.

VISIT	LESSON SCENARIO	REPAIR DEPTH
1st	The scenario card for the day	Full Repair Packet and Repair Menu
2nd	A new card close to the student's own pattern	Adds: "What was different this time? What got in the way of the pause?"
3rd	The student helps plan what the kid on the card could do	Adds: a plan the student shares with a trusted adult
4th or more	Facilitator flags the student for MTSS student review the same day	Repair continues; the pattern goes to the team rather than more IRI

ADD ▸ Confirm the 4th placement as the point where a student is flagged for MTSS student review.

AFTER THE SESSION

CLOSEOUT, THE SAME DAY

Closeout takes about 15 minutes. Each step uses a form from the IRI Facilitator Forms or the existing Repair Packet.

1 PERSPECTIVE NOTE

One note per student for the teacher. State what the student said happened, in neutral words and the student's own phrases. Do not judge the account; do not attach the raw packet.

2 DELIVER IT PRIVATELY

Hand the note to the teacher, or send it through the agreed channel, before the student returns.

3 ADULT RE-ENTRY BOX

Complete the Adult Use Only box on the Repair Packet: packet complete, repair chosen, repair completed or scheduled, family notified, re-entry confirmed.

4 SESSION LOG

Record the trigger, time block, location, repair, classwork, and visit count. Patterns from the log feed the coaching clinics and MTSS student review.

5 RE-ENTRY HANDOFF

The Plan for Tomorrow sheet goes to the adult who holds the morning check-in and end-of-day check-out.

6 FLAGS

Report any safety concern, disclosure, or 4th placement to the Deans the same day.

LANGUAGE

WORDS THAT KEEP THE DOOR OPEN

Speak to 8 and 9 year olds as children who are learning, not as peers or adversaries.

INSTEAD OF	SAY
"Why did you do that?"	**"Tell me what happened, from your side."**
"You know better."	**"What could you try next time?"**
"Everyone saw what you did."	**"Who had a hard time because of what happened?"**
"You need to apologize."	**"Look at the Repair Menu. Which one fits?"**
"You're always the one..."	**"That was one choice. You get to make the next one."**
"Calm down."	**"Let's breathe together first."**
"Don't let them get to you."	**"What they said mattered. What you do next is yours."**

A student's incident, family, or IRI visit is never discussed in front of other students.

EVERY STUDENT GETS A WAY BACK.

Student Support & Culture · Matchbook Learning at Wendell Phillips School 63
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SAFE. RESPECTFUL. RESPONSIBLE.